

Backend Gap: Guarantor Ward Letter

Customer API does not persist or return ward-letter documents

Prepared for backend team · 04 Aug 2026

The frontend Customer Create / Edit form has a dedicated “Ward letter” upload on each guarantor. After create/save, GET /customers/{id} does not expose a ward-letter field (or a linked document) on the guarantor, so the file cannot be shown again and appears “not saved”.

Ask for backend

Add first-class support for guarantor ward letters: accept the upload, link it to the guarantor, and return it on GET /customers/{id} (and PATCH flows) the same way ID front/back or passport photo are returned.

1. Current frontend behaviour

UI

- Field: `Guarantors!` Ward letter (image or PDF).
- On create/save, frontend uploads via POST /customers/{customerId}/documents with `guarantor_id` set.
- Because the backend has no dedicated ward-letter type/field, the frontend currently falls back to type `guarantor_document` and names the file “Ward letter — {originalFilename}” so it can try to re-detect it later.
- That workaround is fragile: GET responses often still do not surface the file on the guarantor, so the Ward letter preview stays empty.

Related uploads that already work (for comparison)

- Guarantor ID front / back! type `guarantor_id_front` / `guarantor_id_back` (linked via `guarantor_id`).
- Guarantor photo! type `guarantor_photo` (linked via `guarantor_id`).
- Guarantor passport photo! type `guarantor_passport_photo`.
- Guarantor collateral photos! type `guarantor_collateral_photo`.

2. What is missing in the API

Observed gap

- GET /customers/{id} guarantors[] has no `ward_letter_url` / `ward_letter_preview_url` / `ward_letter_document` / `ward_letter_document_id` (or equivalent).
- No documented document type such as `guarantor_ward_letter` (or `street_letter` / `guarantor_letter`) that the documents endpoint accepts and links onto the guarantor for later GET.
- No dedicated upload route analogous to `id-front` / `id-back` for ward letters.
- `attachment_documents` / `attachments` on the guarantor either omit the uploaded ward letter or return it only as an untyped generic file with no stable link back to “ward letter”.

Expected contract (proposed)

Please implement one of the following (preferred order):

Option A — Dedicated fields on guarantor (preferred)

```
GET /customers/{id} !' guarantors[] includes:
  ward_letter_document_id: string | null
  ward_letter_url: string | null
  ward_letter_preview_url: string | null
// or nested:
  ward_letter_document: { id, type, name, url, preview_url }
```

```
POST /customers/{id}/guarantors/{guarantorId}/ward-letter
  multipart: file (+ optional name)
  !' links document to guarantor and returns the document
```

Option B — Typed document on documents endpoint

```
POST /customers/{id}/documents
  type: "guarantor_ward_letter" // or agreed slug
  guarantor_id: "{guarantorId}"
  files[]: <file>

GET /customers/{id} must then return that document on the guarantor,
e.g. in attachment_documents with type guarantor_ward_letter,
or via the dedicated ward_letter_* fields above.
```

3. Acceptance criteria

- Upload a ward letter on create or edit for a guarantor.
- Subsequent GET /customers/{id} returns that ward letter linked to the same guarantor (id + url/preview_url).
- Edit form can show preview and allow replace/delete by document id.
- Deleting the document removes it from the guarantor payload.
- Type/field names are documented in the customers / documents controller docs.

4. Frontend impact once backend ships

Once Option A or B is live, the frontend will stop the “Ward letter — filename” naming workaround and map the dedicated field/type directly onto Guarantors !' Ward letter (preview + delete), making it possible to wire up the frontend.

Temporary frontend workaround (today)

- Uploads as type guarantor_document with name prefixed “Ward letter — ...”.
- On read, tries to infer ward letters by name/type heuristics.

5. Priority / ask

Please add first-class ward-letter persistence for customer guarantors and confirm the agreed type slug + response shape so frontend can wire a stable mapping.

- Owner: Backend (Customers / Documents / Guarantors).
- Blocked UI: Customer Create & Edit !' Guarantor !' Ward letter.
- Related prior work: dedicated guarantor ID front/back upload routes.